

music review

Larger than Life

DELHI When sarangi maestro Ustad Sabri Khan says it was glorious to be alive at the dawn of India's freedom, one cannot disagree with him. He was one of the fortunate musicians who played *Vande Mataram* on the sarangi at the stroke of the midnight hour on August 15, 1947, at Rashtrapati Bhavan. At 15, he was part of the All India Radio with all the qualities of a maestro. If the sarangi is accepted as a classical instrument, all credit must go to him.

Today at 80, he is still as young as ever. Dressed nawab-like in a silk kurta, chewing paan and surrounded by numerous disciples, he continues to scintillate the audience with the sound of his magical instrument.

A child prodigy, who started learning at the age of seven, Khan received his early training from his father Ustad Chajju Khan and then grandfather Ustad Haji Mohammed. He also learnt special tech-

niques from his uncle Ustad Laddan Khan of Rampur, a renowned sarangi player and his maternal grandfather, Ustad Kamaal Khan of Meerganj.

He has now created a style of his own, where the purity of the ragas, tans and layakari (rhythmic oscillations) are maintained. One can sample all of Khan's brilliance in the latest launch of Music

Today—Lifestory of a Legend.

This commemorative album, with four CDs, features rare recordings of the legend playing Hindustani classical ragas. It also includes a booklet that features rare photographs of some of

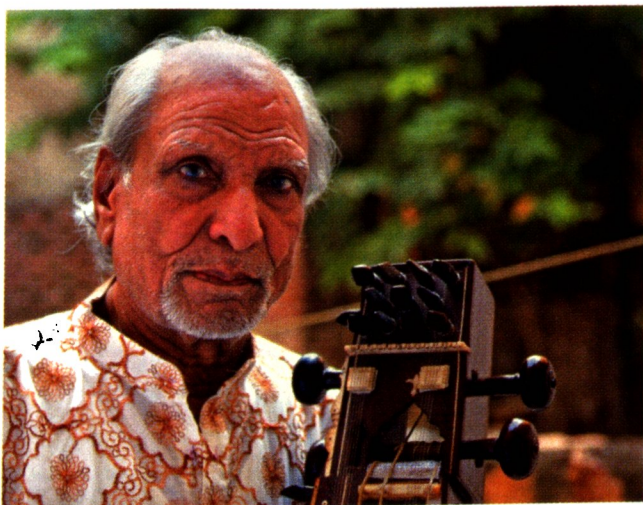
Khan's prized moments from his personal archives. One of the CDs features a few uncommon ragas like raga Lalit, raga Lalita Gauri and raga Saugandh rendered by the maestro, along with some of the popular ones like Nayaki Kanhara, Barwa, Basant, Kedar and Mishra Pilu.

This album celebrates the musical journey of an unparalleled maestro. A must buy for all music lovers. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**



Lifestory of a Legend.
Music Today
CD: Rs 990

THE JOURNEY OF A LEGEND: Ustad Sabri Khan



YASBANT NEGI

art

Rumblings from the Past

BANGALORE Guild Art Gallery and Gallery Sumukha bring together the latest works of artist Arunanshu Chowdhury titled Probabilities of Occurring. Chowdhury is one of those young artists in the country who have made a mark with his bold strokes and large canvases. In the past few years urban society and politics have been his inspirations. Tackling a variety of topics as diverse as Gujarat riots, Pokhran and the fast pace of urban life, his works are largely figurative. Images like the barber's chair and gramophones acquire metaphorical overtones in the artist's work. "My earlier works were mirrors to old memories, which continue to come back to me time and again," he says of the repeated use of similar images. In his present work, however, he has focused on the new generation represented by funky motifs, cartoon images and latest games. Chowdhury has experimented with acrylic, paperworks and mixed media. At Sumukha Art Gallery, Till January 8.

by Nirmala Ravindran

An interpretation of a barber's chair by Chowdhury



dance festival Ode to a Memorial

KOLKATA The second edition of the Prinsep Ghat festival is all set to be held this January. Dancers Priti Patel and Bhanumathi will present their interpretation of the creation of earth, heaven and man. The proceeds of the concert go towards the upkeep of the Prinsep Memorial, which had been lying in



Manipuri dancer Anjika neglect for nearly half-a-century, before it was restored to what is a beautiful structure now. On till January 4. **by Swagata Sen**